Rules cheat sheet

Sacrament

Say what your hero does. The GM tells you whether to roll. Roll high, meet the Target, and mind the Horror.

YOUR SIX SCORES · ADDED TO THE D20

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
force, lifting, climbing, most melee	shooting, stealth, balance, fine work	endurance; part of your Defence	knowledge, searching, most spells	awareness, judgement, healing	persuasion, leadership, presence

A new hero shares **6 points** among the scores (none above 6) and **4 points** among the Effort bonuses below. Each advance adds one more point (page 3).

CHECKS · DO YOU SUCCEED?

d20 + score ≥ Target

- The GM sets the **Target**. Meet or beat it and you succeed.
- **Easy**: Target 3 lower. **Hard**: Target 3 higher. Agree it before you roll.
- A single bonus is never more than **+10**. The Target never drops below 1.

> The Target is 12. You roll 10 and add STR +3: 13. Success.

NATURAL ROLLS · WHAT THE DIE SHOWS

- **Natural 1**: adds **1 Horror** on an attack, a spell or a pushed action, not on other checks. The total still decides whether you succeed.
- **Natural 20**: if the check succeeds, add one extra **Ultimate die (d12)** to the Effort roll, when your table uses that option.
- Neither one is an automatic success or failure for a hero. Only the total counts.

YOUR DEFENCE

- **Defence = 10 + CON + armour.** A foe must roll d20 + its attack bonus to reach it.
- Armour adds at most +5. CON and armour together, at most +10.

EFFORT · HOW MUCH, AFTER A SUCCESS

d4	d6	d8	d10	d12
BASIC	WEAPONS	GUNS	MAGIC	ULTIMATE
bare hands, basic work	blades, bows, crossbows, slings	guns and gunpowder	magical damage	when an effect or a natural 20 grants it

Roll the die for that kind and add your Effort bonus in the same kind. Damage comes off HP; Effort against an obstacle fills its progress. **10 points = 1 Heart.** Your GM may change these dice; read your table's labels.

YOUR TURN, STEP BY STEP

1. Say what your hero does. Agree with the GM whether a check is needed, which score, and Easy or Hard.
2. Choose your target first, and the weapon, spell or item you use.
3. Roll **d20 + score** against the Target.
4. On a success, roll **Effort** for damage or progress.
5. On a failed attack you may **Push** (page 2).
6. Tell the GM you are done. The GM moves the turn on.

BREAK AWAY · LEAVE A FIGHT

- On your turn, instead of acting, make a **DEX check**. Success: you get clear and the foe does not attack you as you go. Failure: you stay put and it attacks as usual. A plain check, never pushed; the GM says where you can run.

WEAPON NOTES

- **Heavy** ordinary melee weapons: **+2 damage**, once (a critical too).
- **Crossbows**: **+2 to the attack check**, still Weapons d6, and a Move to reload.
- **Bows**: no accuracy bonus, but you keep your Move.
- **Reach** weapons: normal damage, plus the reach or control they describe. The GM resolves those.
- No item? An unarmed attack uses **Basic d4**.

HIT POINTS

- A new hero has **10 HP** (one Heart), plus any Hearts their gear grants.

When it goes wrong

PUSH · ONE MORE TRY, AT A PRICE

- Only after a **failed attack**. A failed ordinary check cannot be pushed.
- Once, on your own turn. It adds **1 Horror** and gives you an immediate second action: try again, or do something else.
- The second action cannot be pushed. It gives no extra Move and does not reload a crossbow.
- Outside your turn, only the GM can allow a Push.

THE HORROR · ONE METER FOR THE WHOLE TABLE

Casting any non-healing spell, even if the check fails	**+1**
Casting a healing spell	**0**
A relic or other item (a relic of your own **path** costs 1 less, never below 1)	**its listed cost**
A hero's natural 1 on an attack, a spell or a pushed action	**+1**
Taking a Push	**+1**

Costs stack: a non-healing spell that rolls a natural 1 adds 2.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	**7**	8	9	10	11	12	13	**14**	15	16	17	18	19	20	**21**

At **7** the Horror stirs, at **14** it draws near, at **21** it has arrived and the meter stays there. Past 21 you **pay in blood**: each point you would add costs you **d4 HP** (the GM's own raises cost no blood). The GM decides what each threshold means. It only falls when the GM lowers it or the party rests. Tell your group before you take a dangerous cost.

EQUIPMENT

- **10 equipped slots** and **10 pack slots**. Each item lists its size.
- Only **equipped** weapons, armour, relics and grimoires work. Supplies work from the pack.
- One body armour, one helmet and one shield at a time. A two-handed weapon needs the shield packed.
- At most **3 items that tempt the Horror** (relics, grimoires, curios), packed ones included.
- **Path** (optional): what your hero was before, such as Priest, Scholar or Cutpurse. A path relic costs 1 less Horror in that path's hands.
- Ask the GM before swapping gear mid-fight.

GRIMOIRES AND SPELLS

- Every grimoire takes **3 slots** and holds **3 spells**. You may choose one to start with; the GM gives the rest.
- Most spells check **INT**; healing checks **WIS**. Read each spell for its range, effect and Horror.
- **Damage** and **Healing** spells change HP. **Esoteric** spells (light, movement, influence) are described, and the GM rules on them.
- A **once-per-scene** power is spent when you try it, even on a miss. Resting does not bring it back.

HEALING

- **Bandages** (Close): a WIS check heals **d6**. You cannot bandage yourself while dying.
- **Mend**: a WIS check heals **d8**. No Horror for casting it.
- **Healing relics**: their own dice and Horror cost.
- Most sources heal a hero **once per rest**, whoever uses them. A hero at 0 HP can take the same source again.
- Healing never goes past maximum HP and never raises the dead.

DOWN TO 0 HP · DYING

- You cannot act. Roll **d4**: that many rounds left. Each new round takes one off; at 0 you die.
- A hit while you are down takes a round off instead of damage.
- An ally can **Tend** you with bandages: an **Easy WIS** check. Success makes you **Stable** and stops the count; a natural 20 also heals d4.
- Hit again while Stable: dying again, with a fresh d4.
- Any healing of 1 HP or more puts you back on your feet.

PARTY REST · WHEN THE GM ALLOWS IT

- Every living hero heals **10 HP**, and healing allowances refresh.
- Horror falls by **d10 for every two living heroes**, rounded up.
- Spent supplies stay spent. The dead stay dead.

DISTANCE · NO GRID NEEDED

Close	Near	Far	Very Far
sword's reach	up to 30 feet, a throw	beyond 30 feet: bows, guns	longbow, rifle, or says so

Story, growth and the GM

STORY SPELLS AND ITEMS · WHEN THE WORDS LEAVE IT OPEN

Many spells and relics have no damage die: their words say what happens. Each carries one or two **tags**. **The spell's or item's own words always come first**; the tag is the quick answer when they leave it to the GM. The cost does not change: the same Horror, and the same check where the words ask for one.

TAG	IN A FIGHT	OUT OF A FIGHT
Light	—	Lights a dark place: a WIS check to search or notice there is no longer Hard.
Snuff	A foe made of fire, or carrying it, loses its next attack.	Puts out ordinary flames.
Open	—	Opens or brings down a lock, door, seal, chain, cage or wall.
Learn	Your next attack against the foe is Easy.	Learns one true thing: a secret, a clue or the way on.
Hide	The foe's next attack rolls 3 less.	Slips past a watcher or a sleeper unseen.
Silence	A foe that casts or calls out loses its next attack.	Stops a cry, a bell or an alarm.
Bind	The foe loses its next attack, only after a successful check.	Holds something falling, closing or charging, or freezes or tangles a crossing.
Daze	The foe is Dazed: its next attack rolls 3 less.	—
Guard	+2 Defence until your next turn.	—
Beast	Against an animal: its next attack rolls 3 less.	Calms, asks or borrows the senses of an animal.
Move	—	Gets past a gap, a wall or brambles without crossing them.
Shelter	—	Keeps off bitter cold, foul water, hunger, or the dead rising in a cursed place.

Out of a fight, a fitting tag is one more way past an obstacle or a danger, as the GM judges. *The Last Verse* and *Its Real Name* have no tag: they stay the GM's call.

DARKNESS

- Without a light, a **WIS check to search or notice** in a dark place is **Hard** (+3).
- Nothing else changes by itself: anything more the dark does is the GM's call.

GROWING STRONGER

☐ ☐ ☐ Tick **1 mark** for each adventure your hero lives through to its end.

- At **3 marks**, take one advance: **+1 to one score** (up to 6) or **+1 to one Effort bonus** (up to +10). The marks start again.
- Each advance adds one point to the hero's share, so a grown hero can join any table.

THE GM'S SIDE

- **Monster attacks:** d20 + Attack bonus against the hero's Defence. A monster's **natural 1 always misses** and its **natural 20 always hits**. Monsters' natural 1s add no Horror.
- **Turns:** only the GM moves the turn on. A new round ticks every countdown and every dying hero once. Outside a hero's turn, only the GM can allow a Push.
- **The Horror at 7, 14 and 21:** the GM decides what happens, and says what a risk may cost before a player takes it.
- **Party rest:** the GM decides when a place and time allow it.
- **The GM rules on** movement, range and sight, cover, ammunition and reloading, Guard, Assist, conditions such as Dazed, and anything an item describes in words.

HOUSE RULES · AGREE THEM BEFORE YOU PLAY

- **Natural 20 Ultimate** (on unless the table switches it off): a successful natural 20 adds one d12 to the damage or Effort roll.
- **Scene danger** (off unless the table switches it on): monster attacks add the Target minus 11, if above 0. Target 12 adds +1; Target 14 adds +3.
- **Effort dice:** the GM may change which die each kind rolls. Read your table's labels.